# X

X

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# 震动的音叉
## Tuning Fork TWG-01

The Will of Gears
齿轮的意志

Tuning Fork
震动的音叉

Lab, Suitcase
箱中实验室

X: Fantastic, Regulus! I've tried this experiment so many times, but I've never had such amazing results!
X: 太棒了，星锑船长！虽然我试过几次，但从未取得如此惊人的实验效果！

X: You were the perfect fulcrum! I don't know what I would have done without you.
X: 如果没有你，我真是不知道该怎么办呢。

Regulus: Hmph, have I really surprised you, then? Hah, you've not even seen the best from this Captain yet!
星锑: 哼哼，这就把你吓倒了？本船长还没拿出真本事呢！

Regulus: Check me out!
星锑: 看我的！

Regulus strikes the ball with her cue.
星锑挥动球杆。

The ball rolls forward, coasting along blindly down an over-complicated track.
小球一无所知地向前滚去，毫无逻辑地在莫名其妙的轨道上滑行。

After an incomprehensible chain of further Goldberg reactions, including a toy fire engine and a bowl of spaghetti, the fuse, at last, ignites.
历经了数十个匪夷所思的戈德堡装置后，引线点燃。

Sounding off a twenty-one gun salute in the laboratory, which naturally comes accompanied by a positively wicked rock guitar riff courtesy of Regulus.
伴随着火辣的摇滚乐，实验室内鸣响了二十一发礼炮。

Regulus: Easy as pie!
星锑: 小菜一碟！

X: Splendid, Captain! This exper- ... This show of ours is ready to shock the world.
X: 精彩，船长！这场实……这场 SHOW 一定可以震惊世界。

The two like-minded participants are quick to cheer their success.
志同道合者所在之处，总是充满了欢声笑语。

Unfortunately, one person's honey can be another's vinegar.
可惜汝之蜜糖，彼之砒霜。

And soon, it would not only be fireworks exploding inside the laboratory.
和礼花一起爆炸的，还有某个人的神经。

Mesmer Jr.: Just what in the hell have you been doing in here!
小梅斯梅尔: 你们在实验室里做什么!?

Mesmer Jr.: Why is there a toothbrush stuck in the conveyor belt??? A test tube rack hanging in the air??? A banana peel lying on dry ice??? And why, just why, are there rhinoceros horns in the disinfection cabinet???
小梅斯梅尔：为什么牙刷插在传送带里??? 为什么试管架被吊在半空中??? 为什么香蕉皮摊在干冰里??? 为什么消毒柜里会有犀牛角???

X: Oh, please don't mind the mess, Mesmer. All in the name of science!
X：冷静，冷静，小梅斯梅尔小姐。

X: Regulus and I are just testing out some "new gadgets" ... a rehearsal for a new performance.
X：这只是一场无伤大雅的彩排。我和星锑正在验证一些“新玩意”……

Mesmer Jr.: I'm sure I don't need to tell you just how many safety regulations you've violated. Not that you would care ...
小梅斯梅尔：……我已经不想指出你们违反了多少条《实验室安全守则》。

Mesmer Jr.: And what exactly is the scientific aim you hope to achieve with this absurd contraption?
小梅斯梅尔：请问你们立起这样一个荒谬绝伦的装置，到底是想做什么呢?

Regulus: Obviously, it's for the show—
星锑：当然是为了 SHOW——

X: Obviously, it's for mechanical science.
X：当然是为了机械科学。

X: You might not be familiar with Rube Goldberg machines. Their constituent components may seem obtuse or unusual, but when combined, they produce results of remarkable precision.
X：您可能不了解戈德堡装置。这些零件看起来违反逻辑，但他们组合在一起，其实有精妙绝伦的效果。

Mesmer Jr.: Oh, indeed, like lighting a firework that you could reach by simply bending down.
小梅斯梅尔：指点燃你弯腰就能够着的礼花。

X: Well, maybe ... But, it's the process that matters! Otherwise, why wouldn't we just die as soon as we're born?
X：凡事重在过程。不然我们为何不一出生就去死呢?

Mesmer Jr.: I've never seen any viable scientific experiment involve a banana peel on dry ice.
小梅斯梅尔：我从未见过一种科学会把香蕉皮摊在干冰里。

X: Is science not about exploring the unknown?
X：科学不就是探索未知吗?

As the argument begins to spiral up to its peak, Regulus could not help herself from cracking open a bottle of Dr. Papper.
争吵渐入佳境。星锑不禁开了一瓶胡椒博士。

Mesmer Jr.: I've had enough of these childish fancies! Useful mechanics must be concise and repeatable, not these hair-brained schemes you cook up in your imagination!!
小梅斯梅尔：够了！机械应该简洁，笃定，而不是被你们疯狂的想象力扭曲！!

X: Haha, that's only your own bias at work, Ms. Mesmer. Simple machines might work like that, but it's totally different with complicated systems.
X：哈哈，您说的是简单机械。在复杂系统里，情况会完全不同。

Mesmer Jr.: With all due respect, these inventions of yours are nothing more than meaningless garbage. I suggest you dismantle this ... thing immediately, and return the laboratory to its original state.
小梅斯梅尔：恕我直言，您的发明纯属毫无意义的垃圾。建议您立刻拆除，以还实验室清净。

X: My work is hardly useless. It reveals the hidden truths of the universe! Have you considered that life itself was born from a subtle Goldberg machine?
X: 我相信它绝不是无用的。您想，生命不正诞生于一个精妙的戈德堡装置吗?

X: In the chaotic primordial soup, chemicals collided randomly, forming, by sheer precise coincidence, the foundations of cellular life.
X: 在一片混沌的原始汤里，化学分子无序碰撞，形成了最初的生命。

X: Similarly, in my apparatus, spheres move repeatedly, eventually reaching a stable outcome. It's a transition from chaos to order ...
X: 同样，小球在我的装置里反复运动，最终达成一个稳定的结果。这正是一种从混乱到有序的……

Regulus: Vertin, Vertin! Just in time! I figure they're about to start fighting any second!
星锑: 维尔汀，维尔汀！你来得正好！！他们要打起来了！

Mesmer Jr.: Forget it!!
小梅斯梅尔: 算了！！

Mesmer Jr.: I thought the arcanists here would be ... normal! Must the Timekeeper always be surrounded by these ...
小梅斯梅尔: 我以为科算中心的神秘学家总会正常一些。果然维尔汀身边尽是这种……

选项 / Choices
1. Did you call for me, Ms. Mesmer?
1. 你叫我?

This has been a very bad time to arrive.
很不巧。

The atmosphere around Mesmer Jr. at this moment can only be compared to the sky during the Great Fire of London in 1666. Mere seconds away from inferno.
小梅斯梅尔身边的气压就像 1666 年伦敦大火时的天空。

Mesmer Jr.: Never mind. You should know, I will be documenting my observations of this incident in a forthcoming report.
小梅斯梅尔: 今天的见闻，我会如实写到报告里的。

The professionalism of her words comes in sharp contrast with her barely-concealed rage as she storms off.
撇下这句话后，她便像犀牛一样怒气冲冲地离去了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 特效药
## Potent Drugs TWG-02

Potent Drugs
特效药

Letter: "In conclusion, Researcher X's continued study on mechanical devices poses significant safety risks ..."
信件: “综上所述，X 研究员关于机械装置的研究有着巨大的安全隐患……”

Letter: "It is recommended that Researcher X undergo a thorough investigation for compliance, along with all of his mechanical devices ..."
信件: “建议对 X 研究员和其所有的机械装置进行彻底的审查……”

Neat handwriting, clear argumentation. It makes for another fine addition to the pile of over thirty other similar complaints.
字迹工整，论述清晰。这样的投诉信，还有三十封。

It seems Mesmer Jr. has put no small effort into her report. Now someone else has to work overtime to follow them through.
小梅斯梅尔显然费了苦心。现在有人必须加班。

X: Relax! There are no safety concerns with any of my devices!
X: 请放心，我的装置绝不会有任何安全问题！

X: See, it will all run automatically as soon as you sit down here. And the result is ...
X: 看，只要你先在这里坐下，它就会自动运行，而结果只是……

X: Aha, a flower!
X: 啊哈，一束花！

Thankfully, the subject of her investigation is both cooperative and enthusiastic in demonstrating his work.
好在审查对象积极配合，态度热情。

X: Next, let me present an experiment that uses marbles to turn off a set of lights after a thirty-minute delay! Oh, and then I'll have to show you my machine that uses matches and fishing line to automate watering plants! And then ...
X: 接下来是用弹珠延迟三十分钟关灯的实验！还有用火柴和鱼线实现自动浇花！然后是……

Vertin: ...
维尔汀: ……

X: Huh? Leaving so soon? There's still a ton of apparatuses and blueprints I haven't shown you yet!
X: 哎？你这就要走了吗？我还有很多装置和手稿没给你展示呢！

A love of science is hard to criticize.
热爱科学是一件好事。

But excessive passion in any pursuit can spiral into catastrophe.
但太过狂热也会成为一桩灾难。

X: Are you certain you don't want to review my work again? This is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity!
X: 真的不再审一下吗？这可是一个千载难逢的好机会呀！

Sonetto: Uh ... Timekeeper?
十四行诗: 唔……司辰?

Sonetto: You seem out of breath ...? Is someone chasing you?
十四行诗: 你怎么气喘吁吁的……有谁在追你吗?

选项 / Choices

1. Sonetto?
1. 十四行诗?

Sonetto: Sorry, Mesmer Jr. said you might be here. I just came to check in.
十四行诗: 抱歉，小梅斯梅尔说你可能在这里，我就找过来了。

Sonetto: Did I ... disturb you?
十四行诗: 我……打扰到你了吗?

In fact, she has arrived just in time. Unfortunately, so does another.
实际上，她来得正是时候。
可惜有人来得不是时候。

X: Hey, Vertin! Where were you off to? I thought you and I were supposed to be having fun doing a "systemic review" of my work.
X: 维尔汀，你要去哪？我们不是约好了，要度过一个愉快的科学参观日吗？

Sonetto: Hello, Mr. X.
十四行诗：你好，X 先生。

X: Oh, hi, Ms. Sonetto!
X: 哦，你好，十四行诗小姐！

X: I suppose your being here must mean we have a new mission?
X: 我想你出现在这里，意味着又有新任务了？

Sonetto:
Precisely. The Foundation needs us to relocate an arcanist to headquarters before the "Storm."
十四行诗：是的，基金会需要我们在“暴雨”来临前，转移一名纽约的神秘学家回总部。

Sonetto: The risk for this operation is relatively low. Timekeeper, you've been given free rein to designate your team members for this task.
十四行诗：这次行动的风险系数较低，司辰你可以指定随行队员。

Sonetto: It does seem that this mission's target is rather tricky. Madam Z suggests that you bring along a team member who excels at communication ...
十四行诗：不过这次任务对象的性格较为棘手。Z 女士建议你携带一名擅长沟通的队员……

X: Hey, why are you looking at me like that?
X: 哎，为什么这样看着我？

X: I can't believe you dragged me out here.
X: 唉，就这么被拐出来了。

X: I'd love to help, but you know field missions aren't my strong suit. I'm more of a laboratory rat, you know?
X: 虽然我很想帮上忙，但外勤任务实在不是我的强项啊。

选项 / Choices
1. You won't be going back to the laboratory before the investigation ends.
1. 审查结束前不能让你回实验室

X: Yes, yes, yes ... I will do whatever I can to assist!
X: 是是是～一定积极配合！

X: But aren't most arcanists known for their difficult personalities? What's so special about this guy?
X: 不过神秘学家几乎没有性格不棘手的吧？这次的目标是有什么特殊之处吗？

Sonetto flips through the mission book.
十四行诗翻出任务书。

Sonetto: Our target is Vlad Wilson. Born into a family of potion-makers, he is currently the sole owner of Wilson Pharmaceuticals. It also says he seems to be tied up in some kind of medical dispute.
十四行诗：嗯，对方名叫维拉德·威尔森，出身魔药学世家，是威尔森医药公司的法人代表。
目前似乎深陷于一桩医疗纠纷中。

Sonetto: You're originally American, aren't you, Mr. X? Are you familiar with the name?
十四行诗：我记得 X 先生也是美国人。你听说过这家医药公司吗？

X: Uhm ... I grew up in the slums, Sonetto. Not really the kind of place you just bump into pharmaceutical moguls.
X: 很遗憾，我是在贫民窟和孤儿院里长大的，药业大亨的世界离我稍远。

X: Really, I don't see how I can help with this mission.
X: 看来我是真的帮不上忙了～

X: Maybe you should consider grabbing someone else? I can head back.
X: 现在换人还来得及哦?

选项 / Choices

1. We could let you out here, if you'd like.
1. 你是想现在下车吗?

2. I caution you to remember the subject of your laboratory privileges.
2. 还记得实验室的使用权吗?

分支 1 / Branch 1

X: No, no, I didn't mean it that way ... Please don't kick me out in the middle of nowhere.
X: 对不起，我不是那个意思，请不要将我一个人丢在荒郊野岭。

分支 2 / Branch 2

X: Of course. Aha, I was only joking.
X: 我开玩笑的。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

X: Hm ... So back to the case, how did he get into this medical dispute? As far as lawsuits go, I've heard these types of cases are notoriously tough.
X: 唔……不过他怎么会陷入到一桩医疗纠纷中呢？要知道在诉讼案里，这类案子可是出了名的麻烦。

X: Got any more information in that book of yours?
X: 任务书上还有更多信息吗?

Sonetto: The details of the dispute were not included in the mission book, nor did Madam Z say anything. Perhaps it is a personal matter for Mr. Wilson.
十四行诗: 关于这点，任务书上没有提及，Z 女士也没有叮嘱。应该是属于威尔森先生的个人事务。

Sonetto: It is immaterial to our mission. We only need to coordinate with him about the transfer.
十四行诗: 我们只要交流转移事宜即可。

X: Yes, I just hope things go smoothly.
X: 嗯，但愿事情能这么顺利。

The car comes to a sudden stop. Still a long distance to go to the target location.
汽车猛地刹住了。
这里距离目标地点还有一段距离。

Sonetto: What is it? An ambush?!
十四行诗: 是袭击吗?!

X: No, it seems to be a protest.
X: 不，好像是游行的队伍。

Someone bangs on the car window frantically.
有人在疯狂地拍打车窗。

Crowd: Boycott Wilson Pharmaceuticals!
人群: 抵制威尔森医药公司!!

Crowd: Stop the patent acquisition!!! Give us back our medication!!!
人群: 取缔专利收购!!! 还我的药物!!!

Crowd: Wilson Pharmaceuticals is a price-gouging monster!!!
人群：请务必关注威尔森医药公司的天价收购案！！！

Though they move to roll up the windows, streams of flyers are pushed in before it closes up entirely.
人们强行将传单从车缝里塞了进来。

X: Oh ... You were right, Ms. Sonetto. This whole medical dispute doesn't seem to have anything to do with our mission or arcanum in general.
X：哦……十四行诗小姐，你说对了。这起医疗纠纷的确与神秘学无关。

X: But I think I've figured out what makes this Wilson guy so tricky.
X：不过我也明白这个威尔森先生棘手在哪了。

X: Take a look for yourself.
X：你们也看看吧?

Sonetto takes the flyer.
十四行诗接过传单。

Sonetto: Vlad Wilson recently listed 49 drug patents for sale ... One of which is the only treatment for a copper metabolism disorder ...
十四行诗：维拉德·威尔森挂牌出售自己拥有的 49 项药物专利……
其中包括铜代谢障碍症的唯一特效药物……

Sonetto: And if the proposed sale goes through ... The price will be increased from $1 per capsule to ...
十四行诗：合同即将谈妥……售价也从每粒 1 美元涨到了……

Sonetto: $550?!
十四行诗：550 美元?!

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 马太效应
## The Matthew Effect TWG-03

The Matthew Effect
马太效应

Wilson: Well, what are you worried about?
威尔森：你在担心什么?

Wilson: We own the patent, so what we charge for it is our right! Doesn't matter whether it's sold for $1 or $1000. It's none of their d**ned business.
威尔森：专利在我们手上，这是我们的权利！无论我们是要卖 1 美元，还是 550 美元，都与他们无关。

Wilson: Let the whiners whine all they like. The law is on our side!
威尔森：让那些穷人闹去，法律根本不会站在他们那边！

Wilson: Well, I'm not going to delay this signing any longer. If you don't want to set this thing to my price, then I can always sell the patent to the Brits instead. You get me?
威尔森：签字不能再推迟了。不然我就把专利卖给英国人，听清楚了吗?

Wilson Company Office
威尔森医药公司办公室

He slams the phone down.
电话挂断了。

Sonetto, waiting patiently, at last seizes the opportunity to speak.
十四行诗终于找到了开口机会。

Sonetto: Mr. Wilson, we are investigators from the St. Pavlov Foundation. As per the contract, please return to headquarters with us.
十四行诗：威尔森先生，我们是圣洛夫基金会的神秘学家。按照合约，请您和我们回到总部。

Wilson: Yeah ... Of course. I fully intend on complying with the Foundation.
威尔森：哦……当然，我会遵循和基金会的交易。

Wilson: But first I need to take care of some company business. As you can see, I'm in a "little pickle," and things are far from settled here.
威尔森：但我需要先处理公司的事务。你也看到了，我有点“小麻烦”。

Wilson: You'll just have to wait a few days more until this contract is finalized.
威尔森：在收购合同谈完前，有劳诸位再等待数日吧。

Wilson: Don't worry about it. You and your little investigators can put your feet up and relax. We'll be fully covering your travel expenses while you wait.
威尔森：这期间产生的差旅费，威尔森医药公司可以全额报销。

Sonetto: But ...
十四行诗：可是……

选项 / Choices

1. This isn't what we originally agreed to, Mr. Wilson.
1. 这和开始商议的不一样

X: That's right, Mr. Wilson. More importantly, the "Storm" does not wait.
X：没错，威尔森先生。“暴雨”可不等人呀。

Wilson: Think I don't know that? That's why I've got to hurry up and sell these patents.
威尔森：所以才得抓紧时间卖钱嘛！

Wilson: Anyway, it's not like you've got any choice in the matter. Or didn't you read the rider?
威尔森：再说，这可是你们的分内之事。你们读过附加条款了吗？

Wilson smiles sharply.
威尔森镇定自若地笑着。

X casts a confused glance at Sonetto.
X 朝十四行诗投去一个困惑的眼神。

Sonetto: ... There is indeed a clause. 17.2.2: The Foundation is required to assist in the transfer of property from Wilson Pharmaceuticals ...
十四行诗：……的确有这一条。17.2.2：基金会需协助威尔森医药公司的财产转移……

Sonetto: We will fulfill our obligations.
十四行诗：我们会履行义务。

Sonetto: But Mr. Wilson, if the "Storm" comes, it will be too late.
十四行诗：可是威尔森先生，如果“暴雨”来临，一切就来不及了。

Wilson: Relax, little Miss Foundation. It won't take long.
威尔森：请放心，基金会的小姐。不会拖那么久的。

Wilson: After my acquisition is complete, I'll honor the contract. I've got my reasons for this, you'll see.
威尔森：收购一旦完成，我就会履行合约。这对你们也有好处。

Wilson: Till then, I've got work to do. Now, get out of here. Go make yourselves comfortable.
威尔森： 我还有事情要处理，你们请自便吧。

The protesters are still marching outside the office building.
游行的队伍仍聚在威尔森医药公司门口。

Passerby: Cancel this sale! Protect patient rights!!!
行人： 取消专利收购！维护病患人权！！！

X rolls up the window.
X 摇上车窗。

X: This Wilson guy is pretty smart. I can't believe he got us to sign that rider with the Foundation.
X： 这个威尔森先生不简单啊。竟然能和基金会签那种附加合同。

选项 / Choices

1. Do we just keep waiting like this?
1. 我们就这样等下去吗?

Sonetto: Timekeeper, I do understand your concern.
十四行诗： 司辰，我明白你的忧虑。

Sonetto: But according to the terms of the rider, all we can do now is wait.
十四行诗： 但按照附加条款，我们现在只能等待。

X: But Mr. Wilson didn't even give us a definitive timeline.
X： 但威尔森先生并未给出确切时间。

X: What are we going to do? Just wait around until the very last moment before the "Storm"?
X： 难道我们要一直等到“暴雨”来临的前一刻吗?

Sonetto: That won't be necessary.
十四行诗： 不会发生这种事的。

Sonetto: If need be, I'll ask headquarters for permission to transfer him forcibly.
十四行诗： 我会向总部请示，在必要时刻强制转移任务目标。

X: I'm not sure if that will do much to help.
X： 我想这无助于改善我们被动的局面。

X: Seems like headquarters was fully aware of Wilson's "little pickle." But they still chose to make this agreement with him.
X： 显然，总部完全知道威尔森的“小麻烦”。但他们还是事先就谈好了那种条约。

X: ... Hmm, I see. Haha, so that's how it is.
X： ……唔，我明白了。哈哈，原来是这么回事啊。

X: Ms. Sonetto, I think we've misunderstood the true purpose of our mission.
X： 十四行诗小姐，我想我们误会了这项任务的真意。

Sonetto: What do you mean?
十四行诗： 你的意思是?

X: Sure, Wilson is an arcanist, but he's a businessman first.
X： 威尔森先生是神秘学家，但更是一个商人。

X: He is just trying to seek the best outcome for his interests.
X： 他无非是为了谋求更大的利益。

X: So, after learning about the "Storm," he chose to join up with the Foundation. But he also chose to sell off his patents, and he's aiming on getting the most he can.
X： 所以他在得知“暴雨”后选择了基金会，也在得知“暴雨”后选择了将药从 1 美元涨到 550 美元。

X: Of course, he had to expect that this would cause a lot of trouble. But as long as he's the rightful patent owner, he can sell it to anyone and for any price.
X: 当然，这给他带来了大麻烦。不过他是专利的合法拥有者。
无论开出怎样的天价，只要有人买账，一切就合理合法。

X: Then, he prepared his own retreat.
X: 更何况，他早给自己备好了退路。

选项 / Choices

1. So we're here as security?
1. 所以我们是来当保安的?

X: Mm-hm. You've got it, Ms. Vertin. He knew the Foundation would send someone to pick him up; he also knew he could make them stick around using the rider.
X: 嗯哼。只要基金会派人过来接应，威尔森先生就可以用附加条件叫他们留下。

X: So if the situation deteriorates any further, he'll be able to use us as his shield.
X: 如果事态再恶化下去，他估计就会指使我们干活了。

Sonetto: Mr. X, what do you mean ...?
十四行诗: X 先生，你说的指使是指……?

X: Think about it ...
X: 我想想……

X: Might he not, for example ... make us suppress a riot, if it becomes a threat?
X: 比如……镇压暴乱的人群?

Sonetto: ... Ridiculous!
十四行诗: ……荒谬!

Sonetto: We will, of course, ensure Mr. Wilson's personal safety, but we are under no obligation to follow his orders.
十四行诗: 我们当然会确保威尔森先生的人身安全，但我们没有义务听从他的指挥。

X: Ms. Sonetto, I can see why Madam Z warned you about this mission.
X: ……十四行诗小姐，我明白 Z 女士为何会叮嘱你了。

X: The moment you said "Of course," you fell into his trap.
X: 你在说出“当然会确保”的那一刻，就已经落入威尔森先生的圈套了。

Sonetto: I don't understand ...?
十四行诗: 我不明白……?

选项 / Choices

1. Like it or not, he intends to make this part of our mission.
1. 他会将这变为我们任务的一部分

X: Yes. Just follow the chain of events. All he will need to do is demonstrate that it is our job to "assist in the transfer of property" and "protect the mission target," and on principle, we cannot refuse him.
X: 不错，只要他指出这是“协助财产转移”和“保护任务对象”，我们原则上就无法拒绝。

选项 / Choices

1. But the contract says nothing about suppressing riots.
1. 但这也并非合同明文规定的内容

X: So then the next part is clear. We've got to find a break in the chain and exploit it, before he passes that buck on to us.
X: 所以，这就进入了一个老生常谈的踢皮球环节。
接下来就是看看谁的脸皮更厚咯。

X: Huh? Why are you all looking at me like that?
X: 嗯？你们为什么都露出了恍然大悟的神色，还都看着我?

Sonetto: Sorry, your analysis was so reasonable that I almost lost my train of thought.
十四行诗: 抱歉，你分析得太有道理，我一不小心听入神了……

选项 / Choices

1. Seems like we must entrust this next part to you, X.
1. 这个环节只能交给你了

X: Wait, are we starting to pass the buck already?
X: 等等，现在就开始踢皮球了吗?

X: Well, I can probably keep him safe ... But I'm not sure if I'm the right person for the job.
X: 哎，虽然我有不输给他的自信……但因为这一点被选中也太古怪了。

Sonetto: Of course you are, Mr. X, and I must say it is truly an honor to be on this mission with you.
十四行诗: X 先生，这次任务能和你同行真是太荣幸了。

Sonetto: Your insight has been most invaluable to our mission. Truly.
十四行诗: 非常感谢你的指导，我从中学到了很多。

Well, this mission just went from bad to worse.
大事不好。

X: ... I'd better get out of here before you two find more work to give me.
X: ……我还是先离开这里吧。再待下去，我可受不了了。

X: See you later, my heartless friends.
X: 再见，我单纯又狠心的同僚们。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 孩子们
## The Kids TWG-04

The Kids
孩子们

There's never much fun in waiting around.
等待总是无聊的。

But I'll say one thing for her: She never wastes time.
但她从不浪费时间。

Sonetto: Morning, Timekeeper. Did you happen to see Mr. X?
十四行诗: 早上好，司辰。请问你有看到 X 先生吗?

选项 / Choices

1. Weren't you two just together?
1. 你们刚刚不是还在一起吗?

Sonetto: Yes, but after we left Mr. Wilson's office, X suddenly claimed he had to get some coffee ...
十四行诗：是的，但我们从威尔森先生的办公室出来后，X 先生突然说他要去买咖啡……

Sonetto: But when I went to check, he wasn't in the cafe downstairs.
十四行诗：但我没有在楼下的咖啡店看到他。

Sonetto: I was hoping to ask him to go over the rider again and perhaps draw up a formal proposal ...
十四行诗：本来我还想请他再浏览一下附加条款，起草一份正式的计划书……

选项 / Choices

1. Could you use my help instead?
1. 需要我帮忙吗?

Sonetto: Oh, no, no, please, Timekeeper, leave the paperwork to your capable assistant.
十四行诗：不，这种文书工作交由助手就好了。

Sonetto: But, if you do have time, could I trouble you to help me find Mr. X?
十四行诗：司辰，如果你有空的话。可以帮忙找一下 X 先生吗?

Underground Parking Lot
地下车库

Finding X is not hard.
找到 X 并非难事。

One only needs to consider where someone would go when they're trying to dodge work—somewhere spacious, quiet, and off the beaten track.
只消想想一般人偷懒时会去的地方——开阔、空旷，又人迹罕至。

X: Okay, one more wire to go ...
X：好了，还差一根铁丝……

X: Who wants to provide our final lucky wire?
X：谁想成为这个幸运的铁丝赞助者?

Children: Me, me!
孩子们：我，我！

X finds himself in an old garage, one he has set up in near to the protesters. And in front of him now stands a rudimentary Rube Goldberg machine.
X 在旅馆对面的空车库里。
他的面前摆着一个初具雏形的戈德堡装置。

So far, it consists of marbles, wires, rusty horns, a sprinkler, and a bucket with the bottom missing—household junk.
由弹珠、铁丝、生锈的喇叭、缺了底的水桶等随处可见的生活垃圾组成。

Before him, a group of kids from the protest gather around, looking at the contraption in amazement.
旁边还围了一群看热闹的小孩子。

X: Thanks to everyone's enthusiastic support, our "Fully Automatic Marble Launcher" is finally ready!
X：感谢诸位的热情投资，现在这台“全自动弹珠飞行器”已经组装完成了！

X: Simply adjust the machine to the desired angle and press this spring ... Then we can enjoy a marvelous flying marble show!
X：只要把机器调试到想要的角度，再按下这根弹簧……就能欣赏到精妙绝伦的弹珠飞行秀！

X: Who wants to go first?
X：谁想第一个来?

The children eagerly raise their hands. One little girl is particularly loud in her excitement.
孩子们争先恐后地举手。
其中一个小女孩叫得尤其大声。

X: Mm-hm, ladies first. Let's let Sophie, our prized bucket sponsor, come up and take our maiden flight!
X: 嗯哼，女士优先。就让苏菲，我们最大的水桶赞助商来剪彩吧！

Sophie: Haha! I told you I'd get you back for spraying me with that sprinkler!
苏菲: 哈哈！叫你之前用泼水机洒我！

Sophie lets out a vindictive laugh as she turns the machine toward her companion and presses the spring down smugly.
苏菲发出大仇将报的笑声。
她立刻将机器转向了同伴，志得意满地按下了弹簧。

The marble bursts up and outwards, rolling around inside the bottomless bucket three times, and then flings out high into the air.
弹珠自弹簧迸发，在没有底的水桶里转了三圈，然后又高高跳起。

Traveling through the rusty horn, before it lands right back ... where it started.
通过了那个锈迹斑斑的喇叭，精准落在了……原位。

Sophie: ...
苏菲: ……

Children: ...
孩子们: ……

X: Beautiful! An unmitigated success, Sophie.
X: 漂亮～！看来苏菲已经成功了。

X: You see, no matter what angle you set it at, the marble will always return to its original position.
X: 实际上，不论你将它拨到哪个角度，弹珠最后都会滑回原位。

X: A truly epic invention—a Fully Automated Marble Launcher which self-resets for unlimited use!
X: 这就是史诗级的发明——不用复位，无限使用的全自动弹珠飞行器！

X begins to clap for himself. The response is an overwhelming chorus of boos from the kids.
X 开始给自己鼓掌。
回应他的是孩子们压倒性的嘘声。

Sophie: Hey, what's this all about, mister! You promised me that marble would fly 30 feet!
苏菲: 说好的三十米喷射距离呢?

X: In fact, I promised that the vertical flight distance would be 30 meters...
X: 垂直飞行距离的确是有三十米啊……

Sophie: And what about the "precise targeting"? It didn't even hit 'em!
苏菲: 还有精准定向！

X: A marble falling back into its exact starting position is the very definition of precise targeting!
X: 精准落回原位也是精准定向啊。

Sophie: If I'd known it was just gonna do that, I never would have given you the bucket!
苏菲: 早知道不把水桶给你了！

The kids start into an uproar as loud as the protests outside.
孩子们开始讨价还价。

Mixed in are shouts of "Make a better one," "Give me back my sprinkler," and "I'm telling my mom that you're a weirdo!"
夹杂着“再做一个!”、“把泼水机还回来!”、“我会去你家楼下游行!”的呼喊。

选项 / Choices

1. The atmosphere here is electric, to say the least.
1. 氛围很热烈

Sonetto: Is Mr. X ... putting on some kind of performance for these children?
十四行诗: X 先生……是在给小朋友们表演节目吗?

Sonetto: He seems to be enjoying it.
十四行诗: 他看起来似乎乐在其中。

X: ...?!
X: ……?!

X: Oh! Vertin, Ms. Sonetto?! When did you get here ...?
X: 维尔汀，十四行诗小姐?！你们什么时候过来的……

Sonetto: Don't be so nervous, Mr. X. The Timekeeper just wants to see your latest performance.
十四行诗: 不用这么紧张，X 先生。司辰只是想来看看你的表演。

Sonetto: Right, so what is this ... "Sprinkler" she just mentioned?
十四行诗: 对了，他们刚刚说的……泼水机是什么?

Little Girl: It's the most fun machine in the whole world! It made Sophie cry and call for her mom!
小女孩: 那是上一个机器，是世界上最好玩的东西!
苏菲被泼水机弄得哭着叫妈妈!

Sophie: Nuh-uh! I wasn't crying! That was just water! Water!
苏菲: 呸呸，我才没哭！那是水啦，水!

选项 / Choices

1. Looks like there was quite a showdown here.
1. 看来这里发生过相当激烈的战斗

X: Don't look at me like that. I solemnly swear that this machine was carefully designed to avoid any risk of harm.
X: ……别这么看我。我庄严发誓，我没有在表演过程中让任何人受到伤害。

X: I can explain this.
X: 我可以解释这个，真的。

As X begins to speak, several calling voices are heard in the distance.
X 刚想开口，远处就传来了几声呼喊。

Little Girl: Ah, that's my mom! Guess it's time for my medicine ... again.
小女孩: ……啊，妈妈叫我回去吃药了。

Sophie: Yeah, my dad says we've got to leave soon. So, wanna meet up and play here tomorrow?
苏菲: 我爸爸也快来接我了，我们明天还能在这里碰面吗?

Little Girl: I dunno ... Mom said she might have to take me back to the hospital, but only if "Mr. Wilson grows a heart" ...
小女孩: 不知道呢……妈妈说如果威尔森先生不发疯，她就能把我送回医院了。

Sophie: That sucks ...
苏菲: 真讨厌……

Sophie: Why do we gotta be sick? It'd be cool if we could just wind up a spring and reset like this weirdo's toy ...
苏菲：为什么我要生病呢？为什么不能也拨一下我的弹簧，然后就自动复位呢？

X: Hm? Thought you said you didn't like my Automatic Marble Launcher.
X：嗯？你好像很喜欢全自动弹珠飞行器？

Sophie: Yeah, cause—I—don't—! I'm going home. You can keep the broken bucket, Mr. Weirdo!
苏菲：才——没——有——！
我回去了，水桶就送给你啦，奇怪的哥哥！

The children begin to leave, heading back towards their waiting parents.
孩子们结着伴远去了。

Sonetto: Who were those kids ...?
十四行诗：这些孩子们是……？

X: They're all children with congenital copper metabolism disorder.
X：他们是患有先天性铜代谢障碍症的儿童。

X: I'll explain—but just wait a sec.
X：我可以解释这个——但你们要先等一下。

X lets out a sigh and begins to dismantle his contraption, carefully removing each of the different donated pieces.
X 叹了一口气，开始拆卸起那个由孩子们捐献的破铜烂铁搭建而成的机器。

X: I'll be just a minute.
X：给我五分钟。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 起点，落点
## Starting Point, End Point TWG-05

Starting Point, End Point
起点，落点

Sonetto: So, then, their parents are the protesters we encountered at the march ...
十四行诗：所以，这些孩子的父母就是那些参加游行的……

X: Yes. Their parents have been protesting outside Wilson Pharmaceuticals for days now. So I offered to watch their kids.
X：是的，他们的父母正忙于在威尔森医药公司的楼下举牌抗议，无暇顾及其他的事情。

X: I wanted to give these kids a bit of a break—make something fun for them, you know?
X：孩子们只能自己找点乐子。

X: A lot of them have been in and out of hospitals for a long time, so I thought they could use something to lift their spirits.
X：对于长期住院的他们来说，这段时光就像一个突如其来的假期。

X: Hopefully, they'll never have to know why their parents were protesting.
X：……但愿他们永远不需要知道这背后的真相是什么。

选项 / Choices

1. So you decided to make a toy for them?
1. 所以你给他们制作了玩具？

X: Oh, it wasn't just a toy.
X: 哦，那可不是玩具。

X: I prefer to describe it as a project.
X: 我更愿意用项目来形容。

Sonetto: It seems you're very passionate about this project.
十四行诗: 你对项目十分富有激情。

Sonetto: Mr. X, it was very kind of you to create such an ... amusement for these children.
十四行诗: 没想到 X 先生还会制作这样……充满趣味的机器。

选项 / Choices

1. But there's another angle to it: You got them involved.
1. 并且非常擅长推销

X: A sense of involvement is important for attracting an audience.
X: 参与感可是吸引观众的重要一环。

选项 / Choices

1. But your investors protested the product didn't meet expectations?
1. 然后被投资人抗议产品不符预期?

X: Well, I can't help that. I can't just let little kids run around with a marble launcher that just shoots off anywhere, now can I?
X: 唉，我也没办法，总不能真让他们拿着时速 30 英里的弹珠机追逐打闹吧?

X: Still, seems like I'm not so good at building a "respectable" rapport with these kids.
X: 而且，我可不擅长建立一个“富有威信”的伟大形象。

Sonetto: You sell yourself short, Mr. X. It's plainly clear they like you.
十四行诗: 我想他们都很喜欢你。

X: Aha, well, I appreciate your confidence.
X: 啊哈，我对此还是很有信心的。

X: The way they play reminds me a lot of the other kids, who played in the orphanage growing up.
X: 在福利院时，我常常带着年龄小的弟弟妹妹们这么玩。

Sonetto: Orphanage ...?
十四行诗: 福利院……?

X: Yes, it's a bit different from growing up in the St. Pavlov Foundation, like you did.
X: 是的，和你们在圣洛夫基金会长大不同。我是在那里度过了我的童年。

X: Back then, I had lots of siblings. I would often make machines like this. I'd get them to invest too ...
X: 当时我有很多兄弟姐妹。我也经常制作这样的机器，让他们投资……

X: But later ...
X: 只是后来……

Sonetto: Oh no, did something happen?
十四行诗: 发生了什么吗?

X: —I joined the Foundation, and well, frankly, it's hard to find the same sort of investors there.
X: ——我加入了基金会。于是再也没有那么好的投资人了!

选项 / Choices

1. Is that so?
1. 只是这样?

X: Of course. My brothers and sisters back then would give me anything I needed, just to see what I'd make. But when it comes to convincing adults, like Laplace and Mesmer ... They're not so eager, especially that overbearing complainer.
X: 当然。兄弟姐妹只消一句话就会把零件给你。
但那些上了年纪的拉普拉斯、梅斯梅尔啊……永远不会这么好说话。

Sonetto: Hmm, what was that about Ms. Mesmer?
十四行诗: 我好像听见了小梅斯梅尔的家族名字?

X: Oh. Nothing, nothing. She's a fine colleague.
X: 是吗?

Sonetto: Oh, perhaps I heard you wrong.
十四行诗: 唔，或许是我听错了。

Sonetto: But what Sophie just said does remind me of something Ms. Mesmer Jr. has said about mankind.
十四行诗: 不过刚刚苏菲的发言，的确让我想起了小梅斯梅尔对人类的看法。

Sonetto: "One only needs to press the button to activate the feature. The toggle switch connects the circuits ..."
十四行诗: 按下按钮，实现功能。拨动开关，连通电路……

Sonetto: "If only the human condition could be repaired like a machine."
十四行诗: 如果他们的病情也能像机器一样维修，就太好了。

X: Ms. Sonetto ... do you realize that's an excellent proposition on mechanical theory?
X: 十四行诗小姐……是在谈论机械论吗?

Sonetto: What do you mean? I'm afraid I don't know anything at all about mechanical theory ...
十四行诗: ……咦？我并不了解机械论。是不是我说错了什么?

X: No, no. What you just quoted, or should I say, "proposed," is precisely what lies at the heart of the LSCC's ethos.
X: 不不，你无意中提出的正是科算中心的核心思想。

X: "If we know the state of the universe at some initial time, we can determine its state at any other time."
X: “如果我们知道宇宙在某个初始时刻的状态，我们就能够确定它在其他任何时刻的状态。”

X: The ultimate goal of the LSCC is to build an omniscient, intelligent machine capable of doing just that.
X: 拉普拉斯科算中心的最终目的，就是打造出这样一台全知全能的智能机器。

Sonetto: Is that so ... That would be an amazing feat!
十四行诗: 这听起来……相当的了不起!

X: But I'm afraid this would still not achieve Ms. Mesmer's ideal.
X: ……但这是无法实现你的理想的。

X: Ms. Sonetto, if society were to behave like a perfect machine, and each element would follow a precise and predictable orbit. What would determine who benefits from the system and who doesn't?
X: 十四行诗小姐，如果我们的社会真的像一台机器，一切遵循轨道运动。那是什么决定了谁能得到维修，谁不能得到?

Sonetto: The system ...?
十四行诗: ……制度……吗?

X: The initial point.
X: 初始位置。

X: Because in a measured orbit, everything is predetermined. So we only need to calculate the initial position of any one part to calculate all its states from past to future in the orbit.
X: 因为在轨道上，一切都是既定的。我们只要知道小球的初始位置，就可以算出它在轨道上从过去到未来的所有状态。

X: Therefore, if the ball is set to move from point A to point B, then it might be that wealth is destined to flow from the poor to the rich.
X: 因此小球注定从 A 点走向 B 点。财富注定从穷人流向富人。

X: And because the system is so designed that only those who pay get treatment, so individuals with higher starting points will receive the greater benefits.
X: 付出钱的人得到救治。初始位置高的个体得到维修。

X: It's a rational system and a legal one, for now. No surprises and no miracles.
X: 一切合理合法。没有意外，没有奇迹。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗: ……

选项 / Choices

1. You seem to be confusing social systems for mechanistic ones.
1. 你将社会制度和机械理论混为一谈

X: Fundamentally, there is no difference between humans and machines.
X: 人和机械本来就没有什么不同。

X: Oh, I apologize, I've gone off-topic ... Ms. Sonetto, would you mind helping me clean this up?
X: 哎呀，跑题了……十四行诗小姐，你可以帮我把这里收拾一下么?

Sonetto: Happy to help!
十四行诗: 没问题!

Sonetto: But what did you mean by "the initial point?"
十四行诗: 初始位置……吗?

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 重力势能
## Gravitational Potential TWG-06

Gravitational Potential
重力势能

Mr. Wilson's patent transfer has been delayed now for three days. Today is the last day to sign.
威尔森先生的专利出让合同已经延期了三天。
今天是最后的签字日。

Sonetto: According to the agreement, we will transfer Mr. Wilson to headquarters immediately after the contract is signed.
十四行诗: ……按照约定，我们会在合同签订后立刻将威尔森先生转移至总部。

Sonetto: But now ...
十四行诗: 但现在的情况……

Protester: Price gougers kill!!! Give us back our money!!!
示威者：抵制天价药！！！还我救命钱！！！

Police: Back! Get back!!
警察：退开！退开！！

A raging protest surrounds the Wilson Pharmaceuticals building, waiting for his car to depart.
暴乱的群众将威尔森医药公司的大楼团团围住，只等他的轿车开出。

Once the contract is signed, the only effective drug for a serious copper metabolism disorder will rise from $1 to $550.
合同生效后，铜代谢障碍症的唯一特效药物就会从 1 美元变为 550 美元。

For both sides, this seems to be their last chance.
这对双方来说，都是最后的机会。

Male Clerk: Hello, are you from the St. Pavlov Foundation? We're with Mr. Wilson.
男性职员：您好，诸位是圣洛夫基金会的成员吗？我们是威尔森公司的员工。

Male Clerk: We'd like to ask you to accompany us to the signing location to keep things under control.
男性职员：请你们和我们一起去签字现场，维持秩序。

选项 / Choices

1. I'm sure you understand that is not our responsibility.
1. 这不属于我们的义务

Male Clerk: According to the rider you signed with Mr. Wilson, the Foundation must assist Wilson Pharmaceuticals in the transfer of all property. These patents are the company's property.
男性职员：根据威尔森先生和你们签订的附加条约，基金会需协助威尔森医药公司的财产转移。

Male Clerk: Please understand, we are only asking you to act in accordance with the contract.
男性职员：请理解，我们也是依据合约行事。

Sonetto: I understand. We will do what we must to assist you.
十四行诗：……我明白了，我来协助你们。

选项 / Choices

1. Sonetto?
1. 十四行诗?

Male Clerk: Just you, Miss?
男性职员：只有你吗，小姐?

Sonetto: Nowhere in the contract does it specify the number of people that must be present during this transfer.
十四行诗：合同上并未规定人数。

Sonetto: The Timekeeper has more important tasks, so this obligation will be fulfilled by me as her assistant.
十四行诗：司辰有更重要的任务，这项义务由身为助手的我代为履行即可。

Male Clerk: Of course, I'm certain we can trust in your capabilities as an agent of the St. Pavlov Foundation.
男性职员：当然，我们信任圣洛夫基金会的实力。

Male Clerk: Please follow me.
男性职员：请和我来。

选项 / Choices

1. ...
1. ……

Sonetto: Not to worry, Timekeeper. I'll decide whether it is necessary to activate our emergency plan to protect Mr. Wilson as the situation develops.
十四行诗：不用担心，司辰。我会根据实际情况，决定是否启动紧急预案，保护威尔森先生的人身安全。

Sonetto: You and Mr. X should take this time to make preparations for the transfer.
十四行诗：请你和 X 先生在这段时间做好转移准备。

Sonetto and the clerks from Wilson Pharmaceuticals take their leave.
十四行诗和威尔森医药公司的人离开了。

Everything is proceeding just as X said it would, yet the prophet himself is not present.
一切都如 X 所料，预言家却并未到场。

Instead, on the roof of an abandoned high-rise building, a lone figure stands against the wind.
而在无人问津的小巷里，废弃的高楼之上，却有人影在风中孑立。

X: ...
X: ……

X: "If there is an intelligence that can understand all the forces that bring vitality to nature ..."
X: “若有一种智慧，能理解这世上所有令自然焕发勃勃生机的力……”

X: "And all the elements and things that constitute nature and their current states ..."
X: “以及一切构成自然的元素事物与它们的当下状态……”

X: "And this intelligence is great enough to analyze all this data ..."
X: “且这种智慧足够庞大，以至于能将这一切数据用于分析……”

X: "Then from the largest object in the universe to the smallest particle, the movements of every body in time and space can be encompassed in the same formula ..."
X: “那么大到宇宙中最庞大的物体，小到粒子中最微小的一种，所有运动都将被它囊括在同一条公式之中……”

X: "For this intelligence, nothing is uncertain. The future will unwind before it with the same certainty that the past does."
X: “对这种智慧来说，没有什么是含糊不定的。未来，也只会像过去般出现在它眼前。”

The wind rustles the pages of the book.
风簌簌吹拂着书页。

X: What a beautiful discourse, Mr. Laplace.
X: ……多么优美的论述啊，拉普拉斯先生。

X: It's just a pity ... The butterfly has already flapped its wings.
X: 只可惜……有一只蝴蝶已经扇动了翅膀。

X: When you were erecting that perfect machine, did you ever think that even the smallest gears might have a will of their own?
X: 你们在搭建完美大厦时，可曾想过齿轮也有意志?

The protesters are gathered in front of Wilson Pharmaceuticals.
人们聚集在威尔森医药公司的楼下。

The rage of the crowd is growing to a fever pitch.
他们的愤怒越来越高。

Crowd: Down with Wilson!!! Wilson has blood on his hands.
人群：抵制天价药！抵制威尔森！！！

Security Guard: D**n it, we won't be able to get out ...!
警卫：该死，我拦不住他们……！

Sonetto: Allow me.
十四行诗：……请让我来。

Sonetto: Sonetto takes a deep breath.
十四行诗：十四行诗深呼一口气。

Sonetto: May the peace be with us.
十四行诗：愿和平与我们同在。

Then, she lifts her arms high—
然后，她高举手臂——

Sonetto: Via Pellar!
十四行诗：畅通无阻！

A simple and harmless arcane skill.
一个最基础、安全、无害的神秘术。

It grants a blessing to the road, so that Wilson's car is able to safely drive away despite the crowds.
为道路施加祝福，以供威尔森的轿车可以不顾人潮的阻碍，安全驶出。

The headlights come on. Everyone can only watch as Wilson's car speeds away, harmlessly passing through the crowd.
车灯亮起。人们只看到，威尔森的轿车冲了出来。

Wilson: Useless whiners, what do these idiots know ...?
威尔森：烦死了，你们懂什么……

Wilson: It costs money to go to London, to develop a drug, to avoid the "Storm," to come back ... Everything costs money.
威尔森：去伦敦要钱，研发药物要钱，躲避“暴雨”要钱，东山再起要钱，做什么都需要钱……

Wilson: Besides, why should I care about things like ethics when the "Storm" is about to wash away everything?
威尔森：既然“暴雨”注定会洗刷一切，那坚守道德又有何意义？

Wilson: I don't have time for this. Get out of the way, you stupid bastard!
威尔森：让开！贱民！

Wilson pushes his driver out, taking the wheel of his car and slamming on the gas pedal.
威尔森不顾一切地冲了出来。

Sonetto: ...!?
十四行诗：……!?

**选项 / Choices**

1. Sonetto!
1. 十四行诗！

The smoke disperses.
烟土散去。

The crowd has instinctively retreated from the crash, forming a large circle.
人群已经自觉退开了一大圈。

Smoke billows out from Wilson's black car. It has crumpled up like a crushed soda can.
威尔森的黑色轿车还停在那里，冒着青烟，像被踩扁的易拉罐。

A sudden and unexpected accident.
它的突进被一起意外事故阻止了。

Sonetto: ...!
十四行诗：……！

Crowd: ... Oh My God ...!
人群：……上帝啊……！

Crowd: Wilson is dead!!!
人群：威尔森死了！！！

Crowd: He was crushed by his own company's sign falling down!!
人群：被自己公司的招牌掉下来砸死了！！

Crowd: Seems like God finally took an interest! Hallelujah!
人群：这是您的旨意吗！？上帝啊！！！

Sonetto: How could this have happened ...?
十四行诗：……怎么会这样……

选项 / Choices

1. ...
1. ……

Perhaps it is only a momentary illusion. But it seems to Vertin that she has spied the fluctuation of an arcane skill not far way on an abandoned high-rise.
或许是一瞬的错觉。
不远处的废弃高楼顶部，传来了神秘术的波动。

Yet, a second look confirms there is no one to be seen.
但再看过去时，那里已经空无一人。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 沉默的装置
## Silent Machine TWG-07

Silent Machine
沉默的装置

Hallway, Foundation
基金会走廊

Sonetto: I'm terribly sorry, Timekeeper. We've failed our mission. I should have done something sooner ...
十四行诗：很抱歉，司辰。任务失败了。如果我更早采取措施……

选项 / Choices

1. This wasn't your fault, Sonetto.
1. 不是你的责任

2. I'm afraid it was completely unavoidable.
2. 这是不可抗力

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Sonetto: No, no need to comfort me, Timekeeper. I'm prepared to take full responsibility.
十四行诗：不用安慰我，我会承担起责任。

Messenger: Sonetto!
传讯员：十四行诗！

Sonetto: ... Yes!
十四行诗：……是！

Sonetto: Well, I'm going in.
十四行诗：那么，我先进去了。

Sonetto disappears through the door to the interrogation room.
十四行诗的身影消失在审讯室门内。

X: Ah, I should have expected we'd fall into some trouble when we returned to the Foundation.
X：哎，没想到会以被问责的形式回到基金会。

X: Seems like I'm not cut out for field missions.
X：果然我还是不适合出外勤任务啊～

选项 / Choices

1. Is that really the story you're going with?
1. 是你做的吧?

X: What? We haven't even entered the interrogation room, and you're already starting to question me?
X：……什么？我们还没进审讯室，你就要开始盘问我了吗?

选项 / Choices

1. Don't change the subject, Mr. X.
1. 请不要岔开话题

X: Fine. But before you begin, let me ask first ...
X：好吧。既然你这么问了，那我也要反问……

X: What makes you think I did anything?
X：证据呢?

选项 / Choices

1. Your absence at the scene was noted. Convenient, even—
1. 你当时不在现场

X: I was just playing games with the kids. You read the report.
X：我当时在和孩子们做游戏。

X: I'm sure you'll find they all passed the Lie Detector test that was administered, verifying my whereabouts at the time.
X：他们每个人都通过了基金会的测谎术检测。有报告为证。

选项 / Choices

1. Sound of gears was heard at the crime scene.
1. 案发现场有齿轮的声音

X: And I'm sure you also read that the report concluded that there was a loose part on the sign. As for gears, come on, it's New York. That could have been anything!
X：案件已被查明是招牌的吊索松动。有齿轮声音是非常正常的。

选项 / Choices

1. It's easy to fake an accident with Goldberg Machine.
1. 用戈德堡伪装事故易如反掌

X: All of life is a Rube Goldberg machine. The only question is the outcome, and the initial point.
X: 这我并不否认。

X: But you're asking "Did I make it." If I did, where was its fulcrum? There wasn't any trace of a machine at the scene.
X: 但现场真的有一台这样的机器吗？如果有，它的支点又在哪里？

选项 / Choices

1. ...
1. ……

Thoughts begin to race.
思绪开始转动。

Ultimately, X is the common feature of every Goldberg apparatus ...
想想吧，X 每一次戈德堡装置的共同点……

From Regulus's firework lighting cue.
星锑挥动的球杆。

To Sophie's marble launching spring.
苏菲用手拨动的簧片。

Human action is the initial point for every mechanical device. The participants themselves are a part of the experiment. Their behavior, their actions, engineered as a part of the machine.
用人力作为机械装置的起点。一个行为被设计好的实验者。

Stable, controllable, and able to follow instructions.
稳定、可控、听从指示。

Sonetto: Via Pellar!
十四行诗: 畅通无阻！

选项 / Choices

1. Your fulcrum was a person.
1. 支点是人

选项 / Choices

1. You used her. You used Sonetto.
1. 你利用了十四行诗

X: I don't know what you could possibly mean.
X: ……我不太明白你的意思。

X: We both know I wasn't there. So how could I have controlled Ms. Sonetto's actions?
X: 我当时都不在现场，又如何能控制十四行诗小姐的行为呢？

X: Are you trying to say that Ms. Sonetto acted as my accomplice?
X: 难道你想指出，十四行诗小姐是共犯吗？

X: That's a very serious accusation, wouldn't you say?
X: 这样的指控对十四行诗小姐来说，是否太激进了一点呢？

选项 / Choices

1. ... You!
1. ……你！

Messenger: Vertin!
传讯员：维尔汀！

X: Tsk, they're calling you, Vertin.
X：啧，大人物们在呼唤了。

X: Maybe we can talk more after this?
X：我们出来再继续聊聊吧?

Interrogation Room
审讯室

Inquisitor: So, do you have any additional information to add about the incident? Anything that could help would be welcome, Timekeeper.
审讯员：……那么，关于这起事故的经过，你还有补充吗？任何细节都可以。

Inquisitor: Please answer honestly.
审讯员：务必诚实回答。

Silence.
沉默。

At first, the choice to speak up would have only implicated one person.
这本来只是涉及一个人的选择。

But that is no longer the case.
但如今已不再如此。

选项 / Choices

1. I have shared all the information I know.
1. ……我已提供完所有已知的信息

Inquisitor: I understand. Thank you for your cooperation.
审讯员：明白了，感谢你的配合。

The wait for the verdict drags on, a sword hanging over the heads of two friends, dangling on a thread.
等待结果的时间无比漫长。

Finally ...
终于……

Sonetto: Timekeeper! Great! I've been looking for you!
十四行诗：司辰！太好了，你在这里。

Sonetto: I'm to inform you that the Foundation has dismissed their investigation.
十四行诗：我是来通知你的。基金会取消了对我们的审讯。

选项 / Choices

1. Dismissed?
1. 取消了?

Sonetto: The results from the crime scene found no trace of unexpected arcane activity. The case has been officially ruled an accident.
十四行诗：基金会详细核查了案发现场，没有发现任何神秘学活动痕迹。案件以意外事故结案。

Sonetto: Still, I'm planning on staying late at the Foundation, so I can volunteer for the very next mission. I must rectify this blot on our record!
十四行诗：我会留在基金会等待下一个任务，以弥补这次失败。

Sonetto: Are you leaving?
十四行诗：……你要回去了吗?

选项 / Choices

1. Yes. I have something to take care of.
1. 我还有一点事

Sonetto: Oh, alright. Well ... See you soon.
十四行诗：……好的，那……再见。

Sonetto: By the way, it seems like the patent acquisition was terminated after Mr. Wilson's accident. So, it seems the price of the drug will remain $1!
十四行诗：对了，听说专利收购也终止了。药价依然是 1 美元！

Could this truly have been God's will?
难道真有“上帝”的意志?

Or perhaps it was there a Devil in the machine?
又或者，那只是一个善于伪装的“恶魔”?

X: You look angry.
X: 你看起来很生气。

选项 / Choices

1. Did you know—Did you see this coming?
1. 你早就预料到了这一切?

X: You're overestimating my skills, Ms. Vertin.
X: 你太高估我了。

X: Arcanists are good with intuitive insight, and humans are good with logic-based deduction.
X: 只能说，神秘学家擅长基于直觉的洞悉，人类则擅长基于逻辑的推演。

X: When the two compete against each other, they might turn a blind eye to the absurdity and chaos that is the world and what happens to certain people in it.
X: 二者互相挤兑，却对此外的荒谬和混沌视而不见。

选项 / Choices

1. ...
1. ……

X: Vertin, I am sorry about the accident.
X: 维尔汀，对这起意外事故的发生，我很遗憾。

X: But "the rain falls on the just and the unjust alike," isn't that what they say?
X: 不过石头本就会公平地砸在每个人头上，不是吗?

X: Arcanists and humans, the poor and the rich. As long as we all walk this earth, we're all the same.
X: 无论是神秘学家，还是人类。穷人，还是富人。只要脚踩在大地上，就都是一样的。

X: That's just how the world works.
X: 这才是世界本来的模样。

选项 / Choices

1. So, are we all just cogs in the machine to you?
1. 我们对于你也只是装置的一环吗?

X: When the marble is set, it doesn't really matter who triggers the spring. Its flight and its target will always be the same.
X: 小球已经位于击发点。谁来拨动簧片，都是一样的。

X: In fact, when you consider the mechanistic nature of reality, we're all cogs of one kind or another.
X: 而且，在那台无比巨大的机器面前，我们都是齿轮。

选项 / Choices

1. But you used your friend. My friend.
1. 但你利用了同伴

选项 / Choices

1. You used her.
1. 你利用了她

X: That's why you're upset? ... Hm, well, I understand.
X: 这才是你生气的原因吗？……唔，我想我明白了。

X: Don't worry ... I promise you won't see anymore "devices that pose safety risks" in the laboratory after this.
X: 请放心……以后你不会再看见任何“有安全隐患的装置”出现在实验室里。

X turns to leave, but stops again.
X 转身离去，又停下了脚步。

X: —Oh, now that their investigation is over, would you mind if I took some of these letters off your hands?
X: ——对了，既然审查已经结束，这些原始材料我就拿走了？

The mechanical expert smiles, waving the documents back at her before disappearing through the laboratory doorway.
机械专家笑着挥了挥手上的文件，消失在了实验室的门口。

The fireplace burns low and quiet.
壁炉安静地燃烧着。

X: "... In conclusion, Researcher X's study on mechanical devices poses significant safety risks ..."
X: “……综上所述，X 研究员关于机械装置的研究拥有巨大的安全隐患……”

X: "Which, through unintended consequences, might result in damages, including but not limited to burns, collisions, disabilities, death, etc."
X: “可能带来包括并不限于灼伤、致残、死亡等一系列意外事故……”

X takes a sip of his coffee, marveling with pride at the words as he raises the letter into the air.
X 抿了一口咖啡，赞叹不已地将信件举到空中。

X: A marvelous insight. These machines certainly have their dangers.
X: ……多么美妙的真知灼见啊。

X: Burning ... That certainly is a risk.
X: 可惜真理总是烫人的。

X taps the edge of his cup, beginning a series of outrageous mechanical movements, as Mesmer's stack of complaints is pulled one by one from his desk and funneled into the fireplace.
X 敲敲杯沿。一连串匪夷所思的机械运动后，小梅斯梅尔的投诉信缓缓飞出，滑入壁炉。

Where they turn to ash, leaving not a single trace.
它们安静地灼烧着，很快便化为了灰烬。

THE END
THE END